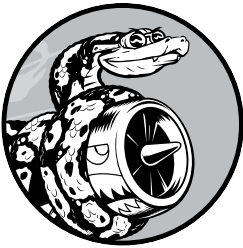


5

IF STATEMENTS



Programming often involves examining a set of conditions and deciding which action to take based on those conditions.

Python's `if` statement allows you to examine the current state of a program and respond appropriately to that state.

In this chapter, you'll learn to write conditional tests, which allow you to check any condition of interest. You'll learn to write simple `if` statements, and you'll learn how to create a more complex series of `if` statements to identify when the exact conditions you want are present. You'll then apply this concept to lists, so you'll be able to write a `for` loop that handles most items in a list one way but handles certain items with specific values in a different way.